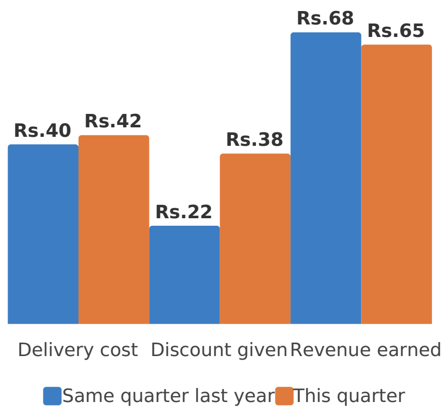
QuickBite case, solved

Sales & Marketing case study | Framework: VRIO

The framework, in plain words

VRIO checks if a company's strength is a real advantage, or just a nice feature. Ask four questions: Is it Valuable? Is it Rare? Is it Hard to copy? Is the company using it well (Organized around it)? Only a strength that passes all four actually protects the business. Anything less gets copied fast.

What money is actually doing



+Rs.6 → **-Rs.15**

Net per order, last year — Net per order, this quarter

Every part of the cost stack moved the wrong way. Delivery costs crept up, discounts nearly doubled, and revenue per order slipped. A year ago each order made a small profit. Now each one loses money, and volume just multiplies the loss.

The VRIO capability check

See table on the next page →

	Valuable?	Rare?	Hard to copy?	Used well?
Fast delivery	✓ Yes	✗ No	✗ No	✓ Yes
Discounts	✓ Yes	✗ No	✗ No	✓ Yes
Loyalty app feature	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	● Somewhat	✗ No
Exclusive restaurant tie-ups	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	● Partially

The only capability that clears every VRIO bar — and it's still underused

Fast delivery and discounts are valuable, but rivals matched both within months. They are not a real advantage, just table stakes. Exclusive restaurant tie-ups are the only strength that is rare and hard to copy, and QuickBite is barely using it.

Q1. Where should the money go?

Into the exclusive restaurant tie-ups, not into more discounts. Deepen those three partnerships, add more, and make them the reason customers choose QuickBite. Money spent matching rivals on delivery speed or discounts is money spent on things that stop being an advantage the moment they are copied.

Q2. Keep discounting, or fix profitability first?

Slow down and fix profitability first. Growth built on discounts that rivals copy instantly is not growth, it is a subsidy war with no winner. Every extra order today loses Rs.15. Scaling a loss makes the loss bigger, not the business stronger.

Q3. What to tell the board on Friday?

Show the cost flip first: profit of Rs.6 a year ago is now a loss of Rs.15, and volume is hiding it, not fixing it. Show the VRIO check next: only the restaurant tie-ups are a real, defensible advantage, and they are underused. Recommend cutting discount spend, holding volume steady instead of chasing more, and reinvesting the savings into exclusive tie-ups until they are the clear reason customers choose QuickBite.

The one-line takeaway

More orders were never the goal. A moat was. Fund the one thing rivals can't copy, and stop paying for the things they can.